

12 Pandorum

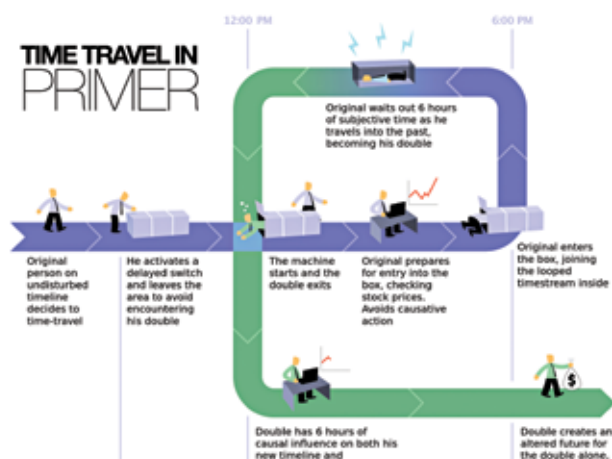
Pandorum didn't receive much love from either the critics or the mainstream audience when it first released but the film has enough potential to act as film deserving of your time. The world building, characters and design are impressive. The film is about a group of people on a space-ship venturing into deep space. When a certain crew member wakes from his sleep chamber not only does he suffer from a mental disorder called Orbital Dysfunctional Syndrome, frequently descending to paranoia, but the crew also has to contend with alien creatures that eat people, which are on



the ship for some inexplicable reason. Although ridden with plot holes the film's portrayal of a space crew suffering from acute psychosis is unsettling, horrifying and even scary at times. You can stay for the cheap thrills provided by screeching aliens feasting on people, or you can ignore that failing and be hooked to the pure dread of the crew, all of what's left of humanity, stranded on a ship on a mission doomed to fail.

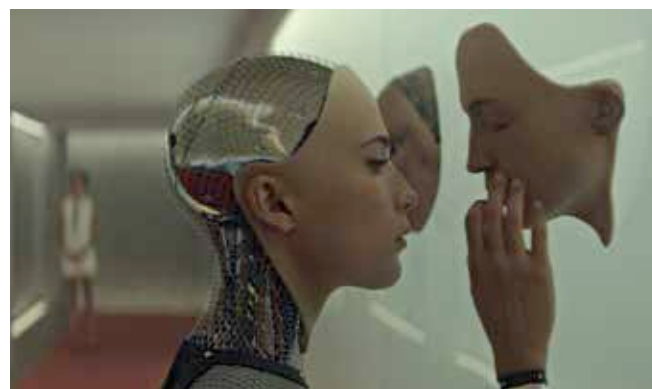
13 Primer

Primer is one of those films that doesn't pander to the audience by dumbing down it's content. It goes all out with its complex time travel plot and nonlinear screenplay. Shot at a measly budget of just 7000\$ by Shane Carruth, an engineer with a degree in mathematics, Primer tells the story of a duo that accidentally discover a means of time travel and try to use it to make profitable stock market trades. But as it is with time travel, the timelines soon begin to mess up, the degree of chaos is amplified by even a small event in the past or future. It's as intelligent a film as any and demands repeated viewing just to fully appreciate its bizarre complexity and tie all the loose ends that crop up in your head after the film ends. As far as time travel films go, Primer knocks it out of the park. It's a deeply technical and demanding film, but all that work you put in is worth it as the film rewards you with a brilliant story and firmly occupies its place as an indie classic and cult sci-fi gem.



14 Sunshine

Danny Boyle's under-rated science fiction film follows a group of scientists sent on a mission to reignite the dying sun by using a nuclear bomb. It's a seemingly impossible mission with a high chance of death, fraught with dangers all the way. Boyle highlights these dangers and along with powerful acting performances across the board, crafts a space film that is supremely entertaining and visually engaging. As with most successful movies, the film hands its emotional core to the struggle of the crew, building the entire premise around that setup. Every failure and decision - emotional or technical - is heightened and keeps you invested. It is precisely this sense of involvement that makes Sunshine such a fulfilling film experience. Directed with Boyle's typical visual splendour and featuring CGI that never feels out of place, Sunshine is one of the best films set in space, ever.



15 Ex Machina

One of the more recent films on this list, Ex Machina deals with a question that has plagued our minds for a long time : Can machine intelligence ultimately beat humans at their own game? The question lies at the heart of the Turing Test, a test that is used to determine if an artificial form of intelligence can hide from a human interrogator the artificial nature of its intelligence. Ex Machina deals with this very question. Caleb, an employee at a large software firm is called upon by his firm's secretive CEO to administer the Turing Test to an intelligent android he just created. Ex Machina has a slick, cool and modern feel to it. It keeps its story grounded and doesn't indulge in showing too many futuristic concepts. The story only has two humans, mostly interacting with a single humanoid, and yet the film succeeds in building tension, guiding the viewer to its shocking climax. In keeping with its realistic feel, Ex Machina's visual effects are similarly minimalistic. The film however bagged an Oscar for visual effects in 2016, beating heavyweights like Mad Max : Fury Road, The Martian and Star Wars Episode VII : The Force Awakens.